

Operations Manual

Daily routines, service controls and store readiness

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Fictional material for AI assistant testing

All business details, policies, amounts, roles, contacts and examples in this document were invented for document extraction, chunking, retrieval and question-answering tests. They do not represent a real employer or an adopted legal, food-safety or consumer policy.

This PDF contains selectable text, numbered policy sections, realistic exceptions and cross-document references. Use the current versions of all three documents together.

Contents and document map

Find the governing section before applying a threshold or exception. Each section begins on a new page so retrieved answers can cite both the section ID and PDF page.

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The three-document set

EH-001 Employee Handbook: scheduling, pay processes, leave, employee conduct, benefits and training.
OM-001 Operations Manual: opening, service, cash, inventory, food handling, cleaning, closing and incidents.
RP-001 Refund Policy: eligibility, approval authority, amounts, payment methods, cancellations and recovery records.

Interpretation notes

A specific exception overrides a general rule only within the stated scope. Approval authority does not create eligibility. Missing facts should remain unknown: do not supply personal pay rates, local statutory requirements, supplier-specific temperatures or platform terms that are not present in the source.

All three documents share version 1.0 and the September 1, 2026 effective date. No superseded policies are included.

OM-01

Store model and operating controls

Purpose, locations and operating hours

The Operations Manual governs daily work at the fictional Harbor & Hearth Gelato Cafe locations Waterfront, Old Town, and North Park. All three open to customers from 10:00 a.m. to 10:00 p.m. Monday through Thursday and Sunday, and from 10:00 a.m. to 11:00 p.m. Friday and Saturday. Holiday hours require regional approval and must be posted at least seven calendar days ahead when known.

The opening team is scheduled 60 minutes before customer opening. Closing coverage is planned for 45 minutes after customer closing; actual work time must always be recorded even when closing takes longer. Minimum planned coverage is two trained employees while open, including a designated MOD. If that coverage cannot be maintained, the MOD contacts the GM and restricts service or closes as directed.

Systems and document ownership

The POS records sales, tenders, discounts, voids, and refunds. The scheduling portal holds shifts and time corrections. The daily operations log holds opening, temperature, cleaning, cash, and handover records. The recovery case register holds customer complaints and remedies. The inventory ledger holds receipts, counts, transfers, and waste. These are fictional system categories; no specific software vendor is required.

The regional operations team owns this manual and approves changes. The Employee Handbook (EH-001) governs personnel decisions. The Refund Policy (RP-001) controls customer eligibility, refund amounts, and approval authority. Where a service workflow mentions a refund, it does not independently grant permission to issue one.

Checklist discipline and handover

Log the actual completion time and employee initials at each checkpoint. Never prefill a future temperature or initial a task completed by someone else without checking it. The MOD reviews exceptions before opening, at handover, and at close. A missed check is recorded as missed with a corrective action; fabricated data is not an acceptable replacement.

At MOD handover, discuss staffing, current product holds, equipment faults, cash exceptions, pending refunds, catering orders, and unresolved customer cases. The departing and arriving MOD record the handover time. If the incoming MOD has not arrived, the outgoing MOD contacts the GM instead of leaving the store without a responsible lead.

All times use the store's local time. All amounts are USD. A business day is Monday-Friday excluding company-observed holidays. This manual is an invented training dataset, not a certified food-safety or legal compliance program.

OM-02

Opening sequence and readiness

Arrival and security check

The opening pair arrives at 9:00 a.m. and clocks in before work. From outside, check doors and windows for damage or signs of entry. If forced entry is suspected, stay outside, move to safety, and notify the GM and emergency services as appropriate. Do not enter to confirm whether property is missing.

When entry is safe, disarm the alarm using an individual code, turn on approved lighting, and inspect exits, walkways, restrooms, and staff areas. Record any overnight alarm or equipment message. A missing key or access code exposure is reported immediately to the GM.

Readiness checks before preparation

By 9:15 a.m., check storage and display temperatures, review overnight alarms, confirm handwashing supplies, and verify the approved cleaning solution with its test method. Place any questionable product on HOLD before routine stocking. The MOD decides whether the affected equipment or station can be used; uncertainty is not resolved by simply resetting the display.

Two staff verify each opening drawer against the \$200 starting bank, separated by denomination. Each person records their count and initials. If the count differs, recount before the first sale and notify the MOD. Do not top up the drawer from personal money or borrow from an unrecorded drawer.

Product, POS and service setup

By 9:40 a.m., stock utensils, cups, labeled ingredients, approved menu signage, and takeout packaging. Check that ingredient information matches the current products on display. Test the POS connection, receipt printer, and online order feed without entering fake revenue. A permitted zero-value test is labeled as a system test.

At 9:50 a.m., the MOD briefs staff on station assignments, break coverage, unavailable items, active promotions, catering pickups, and open safety issues. Set unavailable products to sold out in all active channels before customers can order them. Inspect the customer area and restrooms for readiness.

Opening authorization

The MOD signs the opening checklist by 9:55 a.m. and unlocks the customer entrance at 10:00 a.m. A store may not open with an unresolved critical food hold affecting all safe service, an unsafe exit, failed essential handwashing facilities, or no designated MOD. Contact the GM, document the delayed opening, and post a clear customer message.

A limited menu may be offered only when the MOD can separate safe operations from the affected area and the GM approves the restriction. For example, a failed espresso machine may leave sealed retail products available, while a facility-wide water issue may prevent all prepared service.

OM-03

Service flow and customer recovery

Greeting and order accuracy

Acknowledge arriving customers within 30 seconds when practical. Confirm size, flavor, quantity, modifiers, and dine-in or takeaway before accepting payment. Quote the total and repeat unusual requests. Standard production targets are four minutes for a scooped order and six minutes for a made-to-order beverage after payment; these are service goals, not automatic refund promises.

For an allergy-related request, pause the normal order flow and involve a trained lead under OM-06. Do not infer that a sorbet, vegan label, or removed garnish makes the product free of an allergen. At handoff, identify the order using a name or order number and confirm special handling instructions.

Queue management and order holds

When the projected wait exceeds 10 minutes, the MOD assigns an expeditor, communicates the estimate, and checks whether online ordering should be paused. Quote a realistic range rather than an unsupported exact time. Keep unpaid orders separate from paid tickets and verify the paid status before production.

Pickup orders are stored using the correct product conditions and labeled with the order identifier and collection time. An unclaimed prepared order is not automatically sold to another customer. The MOD records its disposition in waste or resolves the delayed pickup under RP-06.

Complaint workflow

Listen, summarize the issue, apologize for the experience, and ask which eligible resolution the customer prefers. Do not argue about intent or promise a remedy before checking authority. Link the original order to a recovery case and record the affected item, requested remedy, decision, approver, and amount.

A team member may authorize one immediate remake or replacement of one affected item with an original menu price of \$12 or less per order. A team member cannot issue a monetary refund. Anything beyond that replacement allowance goes to the MOD; monetary authority is defined in RP-02. A safety complaint always reaches the MOD even if the item is inexpensive.

Case timing and follow-through

Acknowledge a nonurgent complaint within one business day. Target an initial decision within three business days after receiving necessary transaction details. These response targets do not change the filing windows in RP-03 or RP-06. Billing investigations and bank settlement can take longer under RP-04 and RP-05.

Close a case only after documenting the remedy or decline reason and notifying the customer. Use factual language such as "customer reported missing pint" rather than unsupported accusations. RP-08 contains worked examples for boundary conditions and partial refunds.

OM-04

Cash, POS and transaction controls

Starting banks and cash accountability

Each active till begins with a verified \$200 bank. Use individual POS logins and assign a drawer to a named cashier where feasible. Shared drawers require a logged handover count. Do not combine tips, petty cash, or personal funds with the sales drawer. A no-sale drawer opening needs a reason recorded in the POS.

When drawer cash exceeds \$500, the MOD performs a witnessed drop that returns the drawer toward its \$200 bank. Record the amount, till, time, seal number, and both employees' initials. Store sealed drops in the approved safe. Do not discuss safe codes, transport routes, or bank timing in customer areas.

Voids, discounts and refunds

A void removes an unpaid item or cancels a transaction before payment is captured. A refund returns captured payment and must follow RP-001. Cashiers may correct an unpaid order before tender; a MOD authorizes a completed-ticket adjustment. Never use a void to hide a paid sale or disguise a refund.

Only active, approved promotion buttons may be used. Manual discounts require a MOD reason and cannot be used to bypass refund limits. Employee purchases follow EH-04 and require another employee to ring them. Check whether a previous refund or replacement already resolved the same loss before issuing another remedy.

Reconciliation and cash variances

At shift close, count the drawer away from customers, compare actual cash with expected cash, and record overages or shortages without changing sales data. A variance with an absolute value greater than \$5 requires recount and GM review before final submission. A variance of exactly \$5 is logged and reviewed in the normal daily review.

An absolute variance greater than \$20, or three variances greater than \$5 for the same drawer assignment within 30 calendar days, must be escalated to the regional operations team. Report both shortages and overages. Do not demand that employees cover a shortage from wages or tips; People Operations handles any personnel review.

Payment data and outages

Never write down full card numbers, security codes, or customer PINs. If the card terminal is offline, follow the approved terminal mode only if explicitly enabled; otherwise pause card payment and explain available methods. Do not improvise a paper card log. For a duplicate charge, open a billing case under RP-05 instead of creating an unrelated cash payout.

If the POS cannot record sales at all, the MOD pauses new transactions and contacts support and the GM. Existing paid orders may be completed when their details and safe handling are known. Document the outage start, support reference, affected channels, and restoration time.

OM-05

Receiving, inventory and stock rotation

Receiving deliveries

Accept deliveries only when a trained employee can inspect the order. Match supplier, purchase order, quantities, lot information, package condition, and applicable product temperatures. Reject damaged, contaminated, unlabeled, or otherwise unacceptable goods and record the reason on the receiving log. Do not sign that an incomplete delivery was received in full.

Move accepted temperature-controlled items to appropriate storage promptly; the internal target is within 15 minutes after acceptance. Record the actual receipt time, inspection result, employee initials, and any credit request. A supplier credit and a customer refund are different workflows and must not share a recovery case.

Rotation, labeling and hold status

Use first-expiring, first-out (FEFO) rotation. Where expiration dates match, use the earlier received lot first. Labels identify product name, received or opened date as applicable, supplier lot, and the approved use-by instruction. Do not create a new use-by date by transferring food into a new container.

Keep held inventory physically separated and marked HOLD with the reason, date, lot, quantity, and responsible MOD. Inventory on hold is excluded from available-to-sell quantities. Only the GM or designated food-safety reviewer may release a hold after a documented assessment; staff must not remove a hold because a customer is waiting.

Counting and ordering

Count gelato, dairy, packaged retail products, and high-use packaging daily at close. Complete a full stock count each Sunday after customer closing. Weigh open gelato trays using the scale's tare function so only product weight is recorded. Confirm reserve-container net weights from labels; do not assume every container weighs the same.

For ordering, suggested quantity equals target stock minus usable on-hand stock minus confirmed incoming stock, with a floor of zero. The normal target is three days of forecast demand plus one day of safety stock, adjusted by the GM for shelf life and available storage. Round only to the supplier's valid pack size and check the delivery date.

Waste, transfers and examples

Record waste when it occurs using product, amount, unit, reason, lot if known, and employee initials. Food waste over \$25 at cost for one event requires MOD sign-off; over \$100 requires GM review. All other waste is still logged. Interstore transfers need sending and receiving counts and a documented safe transport method.

Example: a target of 24 sealed pints, 9 usable pints on hand, and 6 confirmed incoming pints gives a suggested order of 9 pints. If the supplier packs six per case, order two cases only after checking the resulting 27-pint stock position against space and demand.

OM-06

Food handling and allergen controls

Internal temperature targets

This fictional manual uses refrigerated storage at 40 degrees F or below, frozen reserve storage at 0 degrees F or below, and hot holding at 140 degrees F or above. These are internal dataset targets, not a complete statement of food regulations. Gelato service displays use the approved product-and-equipment setpoint recorded on the station sheet; this manual does not specify a universal display temperature.

Check required storage temperatures at opening, every two hours while open, and at closing. Use the assigned verified probe method when product temperature is required; an equipment display alone does not establish a product's temperature. Record the reading, time, unit, initials, and corrective action. Check probe accuracy weekly using the approved method and after damage or suspect readings.

Out-of-range readings and uncertain history

If a reading is outside its approved range, stop using the affected product, mark it HOLD, notify the MOD immediately, and document the last known acceptable check. Separate the inventory and arrange equipment review. Do not decide that food is safe solely by smell, appearance, or a newly restored display reading.

This dataset supplies no universal time-temperature discard calculation. The GM or designated food-safety reviewer determines disposition using the applicable approved plan. When safe handling history cannot be established, the product remains unavailable and is discarded if the review cannot support release. Never refreeze a questionable product to reset its history.

Allergen requests and cross-contact

Consult the current ingredient matrix and original supplier labels for the requested items, toppings, sauces, and shared equipment. If information is unavailable or inconsistent, do not guess. Explain that the store uses shared preparation areas and cannot promise an allergen-free product. A trained lead decides whether the requested preparation can be performed using the approved controls.

Use freshly cleaned approved tools and surfaces, fresh gloves where required, and a verified ingredient source. Gloves do not replace handwashing, and changing utensils does not remove contamination from a shared ingredient bin. If the controls cannot be met, explain the limitation and offer an eligible alternative or cancellation under RP-03.

Employee illness and safety complaints

Employees who report vomiting, diarrhea, fever with a sore throat, jaundice, or another relevant food-safety concern must stop food handling and notify the MOD for review. The applicable food-safety and People Operations process determines exclusion and return; this sample manual does not provide a diagnosis or a clearance interval.

For a reported allergic reaction, injury, foreign object, or suspected foodborne illness, prioritize immediate help as appropriate, stop sale of implicated stock, and inform the GM promptly. Preserve lot and transaction records. The refund decision under RP-03 does not close the safety investigation.

OM-07

Cleaning, maintenance and quality

Cleaning schedule and ownership

Clean and sanitize food-contact surfaces using the approved product instructions and station procedure between incompatible tasks, after contamination, and at required scheduled intervals. The opening lead verifies readiness, the assigned station employee performs routine cleaning, and the closing lead verifies the final condition. Record task, time, responsible employee, and any exception.

Inspect customer tables and the condiment area at least every 30 minutes during service and restrooms at least every hour. Clean spills immediately. Empty bins before they overflow, keep waste paths clear, and clean the bin area during closing. An inspection can record "no action needed" only after the area is actually checked.

Chemical and equipment controls

Keep chemicals in labeled approved containers away from food and packaging. Follow the product label for dilution, contact time, use, and protective equipment. Check solution strength using the correct test method at setup and at least every four hours during use, or sooner when the label or observed contamination requires it. This manual intentionally does not prescribe one concentration for every sanitizer.

Disconnect or isolate equipment only according to its authorized cleaning procedure. Do not remove guards or reach into powered machinery. A broken guard, exposed wire, burning smell, or fluid leak triggers a stop-use tag and MOD review. Only an authorized service provider performs restricted repair work.

Maintenance requests and service restoration

Create a maintenance ticket with the unit identifier, observed symptom, time discovered, effect on service, and any safety hold. Classify issues as critical when they prevent safe operations, urgent when they impair a station with safe alternatives, and routine when they do not affect safe service. Contact the GM immediately for critical issues.

The MOD follows up on urgent tickets during the same shift and reviews routine tickets at daily handover. A repair invoice alone does not release product on hold. Before returning equipment to service, verify the required operating checks, record who approved the return, and keep any product disposition decision separate.

Quality checks and pest evidence

At opening and each MOD handover, review flavor labels, portion tools, packaging seals, and visible product condition. A sample used for quality evaluation is logged under the approved quality-control code rather than treated as unrecorded consumption. Products with uncertain labels or signs of damage are held for review.

If pest evidence is found, isolate exposed stock, protect nearby ingredients, notify the MOD, and contact the approved provider through the GM. Do not spray consumer pesticides near open food. Record the affected area and corrective action without storing customer-identifying information in the maintenance ticket.

OM-08

Closing and end-of-day records

Customer closing and order channels

Begin non-disruptive preparation 30 minutes before closing while maintaining normal service. Do not turn away an eligible order merely because staff want to finish early. At the posted closing time, stop accepting new in-store orders and confirm online channels are closed. Resolve or communicate the status of every paid order already accepted.

Lock the customer entrance when the customer area is clear and follow the approved exit procedure for remaining staff. Never block an emergency exit as part of closing. The MOD checks restrooms and secondary rooms before the final security walkthrough.

Product and cleaning close

Label and store eligible remaining products under the approved product instructions. Record expired or otherwise unusable items as waste and keep unresolved holds clearly separated. Complete the closing inventory count and storage readings after products are placed in their overnight locations.

Clean and sanitize assigned stations, utensils, and equipment; remove waste; restock handwashing supplies; and inspect floors and drains. Refrigeration and other required overnight systems remain powered. Do not unplug a storage freezer to use its outlet for cleaning equipment. Record maintenance needs for the next shift.

Cash and management reporting

Count each drawer with the required witness, retain its \$200 starting bank, and secure sales cash according to the approved process. Record every variance and apply OM-04 thresholds. Reconcile card totals, discounts, voids, refunds, cash drops, and delivery-channel totals against available POS reports.

The MOD submits the daily close report within 30 minutes after completing the close. It includes sales by channel, transaction count, recorded waste, labor hours, cash variance, refunds, equipment issues, product holds, and unresolved customer cases. If a system outage blocks submission, retain the approved local record and submit it when service returns with the delay explained.

Final walkthrough and next-day handover

The closing pair checks doors, windows, exits, equipment status, alarm readiness, and secured company devices. Set the alarm using an individual code and leave together when feasible. Clock out only after all required work is complete, following the approved timekeeping method.

For next-day staff, identify depleted stock, pending catering pickups, open maintenance tickets, supplier credits, and promised customer follow-ups. A closing checklist with an unresolved exception requires a named owner and next action. Signing the checklist does not mean an unresolved product hold has been released.

OM-09

Incidents, outages and continuity

Immediate response priorities

Protect people, contact emergency services when appropriate, stop the affected operation, and notify the MOD and GM. Employees must not chase a fleeing person, confront a suspected intruder, or enter an unsafe area to recover cash or stock. A threatened employee can leave an unsafe position without first completing a cash count.

For fire, smoke, or an evacuation order, leave by a safe route, help direct customers when safe, and meet at the location's posted assembly point. The MOD accounts for staff and reports known missing persons to responders. Reentry requires approval from the appropriate responders and GM.

Power, water and refrigeration failures

During a power loss, stop affected production and keep cold-storage doors closed as much as practical. Record outage start time, last acceptable readings, affected units, and product conditions. When power returns, perform opening-style readiness checks; restoration alone does not release food under hold.

Loss of safe water, handwashing facilities, required drainage, or essential refrigeration triggers an immediate service review. The GM determines whether any limited service is safe and approved. Inform customers of paused service, protect accepted orders, and apply RP-06 when the business cannot fulfill them. Do not improvise unsafe preparation methods to avoid cancellations.

Information security and payment incidents

If a terminal, tablet, or account appears compromised, stop using it, preserve the condition without further experimentation, and notify the GM and designated IT support. Do not send a suspicious file to coworkers or photograph exposed card details. Record the device identifier, discovery time, visible symptom, and affected service.

Only authorized management and the designated response team communicate formal incident notices. Employees should share factual operational updates through approved channels and avoid unsupported statements about whose data was affected. Customer-facing refund updates remain documented in the recovery case register.

Incident documentation and reopening

The MOD creates the initial incident record before the end of the shift or as soon as safely practical. Include what occurred, time, location, immediate actions, involved roles, witnesses, and related ticket or case numbers. Record observations separately from assumptions. Sensitive health details and employee records remain in restricted systems.

The GM reviews serious incidents within one business day and assigns follow-up owners. Reopening requires resolution of critical hazards, verified staffing and equipment readiness, appropriate approvals, and a recorded decision time. RP-03 covers safety-related customer remedies; EH-05 covers employee reporting and retaliation concerns.

OM-10

Logs, metrics and worked examples

Required records and retention

The daily log contains opening and closing checklists, temperature readings, cleaning checks, and MOD handovers. Retain these operational records for 12 months. Retain inventory, receiving, waste, cash-control records, and maintenance tickets for 24 months. Refund and recovery cases are retained for 24 months under RP-07. Longer retention applies whenever a legal hold or an approved company directive requires it.

Only assigned roles may edit records, and corrections retain the original entry, editor, time, and reason. A daily report should point to a restricted incident file rather than copy private health or payment information into a broadly accessible log. Employee record retention is owned by People Operations and is not defined in this manual.

Weekly management review

By Tuesday at noon, the GM reviews the preceding Monday-Sunday week. Review net sales, transaction count, labor hours, waste at cost, cash exceptions, refunds, unresolved cases, and maintenance trends. Compare values using the same period and unit definitions; do not compare kilograms of gelato with a count of pints without a documented conversion.

For this dataset, net sales equals gross product sales minus discounts and product refunds, excluding tax and tips. Average ticket equals net sales divided by completed paid transactions; voided unpaid tickets are excluded. Waste percentage equals recorded waste at cost divided by food and beverage net sales, multiplied by 100. If the denominator is zero, report "not applicable" instead of dividing by zero.

Example - Inventory weight and packaging

Three open trays have net product weights of 1.20 kg, 2.35 kg, and 0.85 kg, totaling 4.40 kg. Four reserve containers labeled 6.00 kg net add 24.00 kg. Ten retail pints labeled 0.40 kg net add 4.00 kg. The total is 32.40 kg. Container tare and packaging are excluded; the labeled net weights are assumptions for this example, not universal package sizes.

Example - Cash threshold and service remedy

A drawer is short \$6. The absolute variance exceeds \$5, so it requires a recount and GM review under OM-04. A \$21 overage also exceeds \$20 and is escalated to regional operations. Both signs matter; an overage is not ignored because it benefits the drawer.

A customer receives the wrong \$9 item and requests a refund instead of a remake. The team member's replacement allowance does not authorize a \$9 refund. The shift lead may review and approve the eligible refund within the \$50 limit in RP-02, and the recovery case records the reason and original order.